

This cat.



1/9

THE FACTS

One sheet each – print it again for the second ...

Name _____

Called, actually _____

Born or about _____ Came home _____

Colour and markings _____

Breed, or best guess _____

Neutered _____ Indoor / out _____

THE NUMBERS YOU CANNOT LOOK UP IN A HURRY

Microchip number _____

Chip registered with _____

Insurance, and policy number _____

Registered at (practice) _____

A microchip is only as good as the phone number on it

The chip itself never changes and never expires, but the record attached to it does. If you have moved, changed your number, or the cat came from someone else, the details are very often still theirs. Log in once, check it, and write the date on page 3.

WHERE THEY CAME FROM

Breeder, shelter or found _____

Anything known about before _____

PHOTOGRAPHS, IN CASE THEY ARE LOST

☐ Clear head-on photograph, taken this year

☐ Both sides, and anything unusual

☐ Stored somewhere other than your phone

WHAT THEY ARE LIKE

What a stranger would need

Friendly with _____

Not friendly with _____

Where they hide _____

What frightens them _____

How they ask for food _____

How they ask to be left alone _____

Picked up? How? _____

THINGS THEY ALREADY DO THAT ARE THEIRS

OTHER ANIMALS IN THE HOUSE

WHO

HOW THEY GET ON

WHO	HOW THEY GET ON

Numbers, and when to use them.



THE PRACTICE

Vet

Daytime number

Address

OUT OF HOURS – USUALLY SOMEWHERE ELSE

Who covers nights

Number

Address, and how long it takes

ALSO WORTH HAVING

Insurance claim line

Microchip company

Poisons helpline

Whoever has a spare key

Photograph this page once it is filled in

The moment you need the out-of-hours number is the moment you cannot find the folder. Fill it in, take a picture of it on your phone, and put the paper copy on the fridge rather than in a drawer.

GETTING THERE

Worked out once, not at midnight

Carrier lives

Who drives, if it is the middle of the night

How long it takes

PHONE NOW, DO NOT WAIT UNTIL MORNING

- ☐ Straining in the tray and producing little or nothing – especially a male cat
- ☐ Breathing with an open mouth, or fast shallow breathing at rest
- ☐ Sudden weakness or dragging of the back legs, often crying, legs cold
- ☐ Not eating at all for 24 hours, or hiding and not moving
- ☐ Eaten or chewed any part of a lily, or drunk the vase water
- ☐ Swallowed thread, string, tinsel or an elastic band – never pull it
- ☐ Repeated vomiting, a bloated belly, or a fall from a height

This list is the short version of what emergency vets ask people to come in for. It is not a diagnosis and it is not complete. A cat that seems wrong to you is a good enough reason to phone – you know this animal and they do not.

ANYTHING ELSE TO WATCH FOR

The year of care.

ROUTINE CARE

Intervals vary – the vet decides

WHAT, AND HOW OFTEN

LAST

DUE

DONE

Vaccination booster

Yearly

Worming

Every 3 months

Flea and tick

Monthly, check the label

Full check-up

Yearly, twice over ten

Teeth looked at

At the check-up

Claws checked

Older cats especially

Weighed

Monthly, page 4

Microchip details checked

Yearly, and after moving

ANYTHING ONGOING

Medication, a condition, a diet

WHAT

DOSE AND WHEN

REPEAT

APPOINTMENTS MADE

WHAT FOR

WHEN

BEEN

KEEP OUT OF THE HOUSE

The short list, and the reason

Lilies, any part

Pollen and vase water too. Kidney failure. Emergency.

Paracetamol / acetaminophen

Never, in any dose. Also ibuprofen and aspirin.

Dog flea treatment

Permethrin is toxic to cats. Check every label.

Antifreeze

Sweet, and lethal in tiny amounts. Wipe up spills.

Onion, garlic, chives

Cooked or raw, including in gravy and baby food.

String, thread, tinsel

Swallowed, it cuts. Never pull on a visible end.

Lilies are the one people are surprised by: every part of a true lily is dangerous to cats, brushing pollen off a coat and licking it is enough, and there is no safe amount. If a bouquet arrives, take them out before it comes in.

WHERE THE RECORDS LIVE

Vaccination card

Insurance documents

Prescription food or medicine from

COST OF THE YEAR

Insurance

Food

Vet

Everything else

WORTH ASKING AT THE NEXT CHECK-UP

Is this weight right for this cat?

Do the teeth need doing?

Is the flea and worm routine still the right one?

Anything to expect at this age?

Weight, every month.

SAME SCALES, SAME DAY OF THE MONTH – Kilos or pounds
MONTH WEIGHT WHAT ELSE YOU NOTICED

January		
February		
March		
April		
May		
June		
July		
August		
September		
October		
November		
December		

Why this page exists

A cat will not tell you it feels unwell and will often behave normally until it is very unwell indeed. Weight is the exception: it is a number, it does not depend on how you are feeling that day, and a steady drop over a few months is one of the earliest things a vet can act on. Weigh monthly, write it down even when it is boring, and take the page with you to the check-up.

HOW TO WEIGH A CAT WHO WILL NOT BE WEIGHED

- ☐ Weigh yourself, then yourself holding the cat
- ☐ Or the carrier with them in, minus the carrier
- ☐ The same scales every time; the number matters less than the change
- ☐ Same time of day, before food

IDEAL WEIGHT, IF THE VET HAS GIVEN ONE

Ideal Told on

BODY SHAPE, FELT NOT LOOKED AT

TAKE TO THE NEXT APPOINTMENT

- ☐
- ☐
- ☐

Food and water.

WHAT THEY EAT

WHAT	HOW MUCH	WHEN

TREATS About a tenth of the day’s food

NEVER, FOR THIS CAT Allergies, a diet, or just a firm no

☐

☐

☐

WHERE THE FOOD IS KEPT

CHANGING FOOD Over a week, mixed in

Cats are bad at drinking, and it matters

They evolved to get most of their water from what they caught, which is why a dry-food cat can run mildly short for years and why urinary trouble is so common. More bowls, in more places, **away from the food** and away from the tray; wide bowls rather than deep narrow ones; changed daily. Wet food is water as well as dinner.

WATER, WHERE IT IS Not next to the food

WHERE	BOWL OR FOUNTAIN	DAILY
		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐

BOWLS AND WHERE THEY GO

- ☐ Food and water apart, in different rooms if you can
- ☐ Neither of them beside the litter tray
- ☐ Wide and shallow, so the whiskers are not squashed
- ☐ Somewhere they can eat with their back to a wall
- ☐ One feeding station per cat, spread out

IF THEY STOP EATING Phone if it reaches a day



Two cats means three trays, and they go in different places rather than in a row. Most cats prefer them uncovered, in a quiet spot with a way out, with fine unscented clumping litter deep enough to dig – and scooped every day. Almost every “he is doing it on the carpet” problem is a tray problem, a stress problem, or a medical one, in that order of how often.

#	WHERE IT IS	LITTER USED	OPEN
1			☐
2			☐
3			☐
4			☐
	Scooped	Emptied fully	

○ Add the new tray before taking the old one away

- Mix new litter into old over a week or two
- Move a tray a little at a time, not across the house
- No scented litter, no strong cleaners – they can smell what you cannot

Litter brand

Bought from

How long a bag lasts

[illegible]

A cat going to the tray again and again and producing little or nothing – squatting, straining, crying, licking – may have a blocked bladder. In male cats this is a genuine emergency and hours matter. Do not wait to see if it settles overnight: phone the number on page 2.

The indoor day.

Play works when it looks like hunting

Stalk, chase, pounce, catch – and then feed. A wand toy moving **away** from the cat, like something escaping, beats a toy waved in their face. Two or three short sessions a day beat one long one, and every session should end with a catch they are allowed to keep, or it is just frustration. Lasers alone never let them catch anything; if you use one, land it on a real toy at the end.

WHAT THIS CAT ACTUALLY LIKES — Most have one type

TOY OR GAME	HOW LONG	KEEPS
-------------	----------	-------

		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐

ROTATE, DO NOT ADD — Half away for a fortnight

FOOD THAT TAKES WORK - Enrichment and pacing at once

☐

☐

☐

SCRATCHING — Both kinds, or the sofa becomes one

- ☐ Something upright and tall enough to stretch full length
- ☐ Something flat on the floor as well
- ☐ One next to where they sleep – they scratch on waking

☐ One where they already scratch, not where you would prefer
- ☐ Sturdy enough not to wobble, or it will not be used

WHERE THEY GET UP HIGH Height is how a cat feels sa...

THE WINDOW — Somewhere to sit, something to watch

SOMEWHERE NOBODY FOLLOWS THEM

WITH ANOTHER CAT IN THE HOUSE

- ☐ Beds, bowls and posts in more than one room
- ☐ Somewhere each of them can be alone
- ☐ Never fed nose to nose

While we are away.

THE BASICS

Cat _____ Dates _____

Us, and the best number _____

If you cannot reach us _____

Vet, and out-of-hours (page 2) _____

Insurance policy number _____

FEEDING Amounts, not "a bit"

WHAT	HOW MUCH	WHEN
------	----------	------

_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____

MEDICATION, IF ANY

WHAT	DOSE AND WHEN	GIVEN
------	---------------	-------

_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	☐

WHERE EVERYTHING IS

WHAT	WHERE
------	-------

Food and bowls	_____
Litter and scoop	_____
Spare litter	_____
Carrier	_____
Cleaning things	_____
Toys	_____
Spare key	_____

What to tell someone who has never met this cat

Where they hide, and that hiding is normal for the first day. That they should be **seen** every visit, even if it means looking under a bed – a cat that has not been laid eyes on is the thing you need to know about. And that the tray tells you whether they are eating and drinking, so it gets checked even when it looks clean.

PLEASE DO, AND PLEASE DO NOT

☐	_____
☐	_____
☐	_____
☐	_____
☐	_____

MESSAGE US IF



DATE _____

WHAT YOU NOTICED

TOLD
VET

Drinking more or less than usual. Sleeping somewhere new. Not jumping up where they always jump up. Eating more slowly. Grooming one patch bald. None of these is an emergency on the day, and all of them are the sort of thing a vet asks “how long has that been going on?” about – and this page is how you answer.

QUESTIONS FOR THE NEXT APPOINTMENT

WHAT THE VET SAID

WHAT WE CHANGED, AND WHETHER IT HELPED